

for a run with a friend," said Justin Rattner, chief technology officer of Intel while speaking at the annual Intel Developer Forum.

Future devices will constantly learn who you are and how you live, work and play. As a sample, Rattner demonstrated a television remote control that figured out who was holding it based on how it was held, and then learnt the viewer's entertainment preferences.

Sign language on mobile phones

Mobile devices are under testing that could help deaf and hearing-impaired people communicate effectively using video chat. Researchers at the University of Washington, for instance, are developing a system that will enable the deaf to use sign language in order to converse on phone. The device being developed by them can be integrated into any high-end mobile phone to transmit American Sign Language (ASL) via compressed video over a 3G network.

The researchers are working to optimise compressed video signals for sign language. By increasing the image quality around the face and hands, they have brought the data rate down to 30 kB per second while still delivering intelligible sign language.

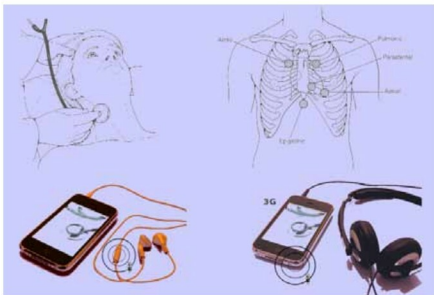
The system also uses motion detection to identify whether a person is signing or not in order to extend the phones' battery life during video use.



Sign language over cell phone

iStethoscope may replace Stethoscope

Peter Bentley, a University College London researcher, has created an application for the iPhone, called iStethoscope, that has the potential to replace the traditional stethoscope. The application can monitor heartbeat through sensors in the iPhone and is being used by many doctors around the world in place of the traditional



Peter Bentley's iStethoscope can monitor heartbeat through sensors in the iPhone

piece of equipment.

"Smartphones are incredibly powerful devices packed full of sensors, cameras, high-quality microphones with amazing displays," Bentley said. "They are capable of saving lives, saving money and improving healthcare in a dramatic fashion, and we carry these massively powerful computers in our pockets."

In fact, in the future, it could be possible for you to conduct your own ultrasounds or monitor blood pressure through smartphones.

New remote control devices

Broadcom, in collaboration with Philips Home Control, is applying Bluetooth and other technologies to enable remotes that can control the

home entertainment experience with the wave of a hand, swipe of a finger or strokes of a miniature keyboard.

As TVs and Blu-ray disk players become more connected and STBs and digital televisions offer more over-the-top services, next-generation remote controls are required that can provide functionality similar to that provided by keyboards and mice for the PC or keypads for the smartphone: gestural

and touchpad remotes provide more intuitive navigation and QWERTY keyboards enable more convenient text entry for easier searches for content.

Broadcom's Bluetooth technology supports standards-based approaches to remote control functionality for consumer electronics products, as well as additional innovations developed to minimise latency and ensure a responsive user experience, even with the most subtle of gestures and movements.

Google's TV service coming

Google is all set to bring the Web to TV screens. Thus it will be sneaking into your living rooms, extending its reach away from its current habitat—the desktop.

CEO Eric Schmidt said the service, which will allow full Internet